

PLEASANTVILLE PLAYGROUND PROJECT

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MIT5662: Project Management

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ENVIRONMENT/CONTEXT

For over 30 years, the citizens of Pleasantville, California have had to walk past a vacant city-owned plot of land, in disrepair and full of trash. This vacant space is full of potential and could be transformed into a communal space for the neighborhood. Furthermore, Pleasantville is in desperate need of a communal playground in this area where families can allow their children to play safely. There have been minor accidents, and a nearly catastrophic accident due to children playing in the streets. This vacant lot is the perfect place to build a playground.

Significant work will need to be done to clean up the area, build the playground, and develop the surrounding area. A group of seven concerned citizens have taken it upon themselves to develop a comprehensive and detailed plan to make a nature-inspired, accessible playground a reality. This detailed plan will be implemented once it receives official approval from the city. Factors to consider prior to building the playground are the opinions/input from the community, environmental/safety factors, and ensuring that the space is as inclusive as possible for the citizens of Pleasantville.

VISION

The Pleasantville Playground Project will transform the vacant parcel into a vibrant and inclusive space for the community, where families can play safely and create lifelong memories.

PROJECT PLAN

Main objective: Build a safe playground for families to use that will be built on a vacant city-owned plot of land.

Secondary objectives:

1. Submit permits and zoning paperwork for approval of building.
2. Fundraise \$30,000 for the project.
3. Recruit volunteers to assist for the duration of the project.
4. Procure materials and resources.
5. Build the playground and surrounding features.
6. Establish plan to ensure maintenance of playground.
7. Ensure the playground is ready for Founder's Day Gala on September 1st.

The functionality and reliability of the project will be addressed with bi-weekly meetings with the project team. If there are conflicts regarding priorities, the project manager will collaborate with the team and choose the safest, most cost-effective task as the highest priority. There will also be a change-management process to ensure any changes are approved/denied the same way.

It is the goal of the project team to create a nature-inspired playground with similar construction to the two playgrounds shown below. Both facilities are known for their accessible and inclusive playgrounds. While we will gather community opinions, we are confident most will welcome these types of playgrounds.

Westchester Recreation Center – Los Angeles, CA



Figure 1 - [Westchester Recreation Center](#)

The Westchester Recreation Center playground features bright ocean colors, accessible ramps, and ample shade for the children to prevent the equipment from getting too hot.

Hope Playground at Whiteside Park – Tulsa, OK



Figure 2 [Hope Playground at Whiteside Park](#)

The Hope Playground provides accessible, fun, and safe options for children of all needs to play. Different areas with varied colors and textures provide wayfinding for children with varied visual or hearing impairments.

BUDGET & FUNDRAISING

The budget for the project is \$30,000 which will be raised by the project manager and volunteers. Local merchants will donate non-cash materials and resources. Fundraising efforts include bake sales, car washes, and the opportunity to adopt-a-bench or adopt-a-brick. Anyone can adopt-a-brick and it will come with a special engraving of their choice that will be laid on the playground walkway. There is also the option to adopt-a-bench, where someone can donate and purchase a bench “in honor” of someone. A special placard will be attached to the bench and will be set up in the playground area. A raffle and auction will be conducted using items donated by the local donors and local media will be invited to feature the event, in hopes of encouraging more donations.

PROJECT TEAM

The seven concerned citizens will be responsible for the leadership positions below to ensure success of the project.

Project Manager: Tricia H.

Responsibilities include organizing, planning, and executing the Pleasantville Playground Project. They will establish and maintain project scope and support volunteer team as needed to ensure the success of the project.

Volunteer Coordinator: Responsible for recruiting volunteers, managing volunteer availability/schedules, and communicating with Project Manager and team leads on all volunteer related engagements. The volunteer coordinator will need to work with each volunteer to determine their abilities and roles that they are most comfortable with, as some of the tasks will require heavy lifting.

Finance Team: Consists of fundraising and budget leads; responsibilities are listed below.

Fundraising Lead: Responsible for planning and coordinating all fundraising events, including day of execution. Works with other team leads to ensure fundraising events run smoothly. Works with community strategist to manage non-cash materials that will be donated.

Budget Lead: Responsible for working with fundraising lead on financial status and keeping budget updated. Communicates with Project manager regularly to ensure project stays on track and notifies of any major changes.

Construction Coordinator: Responsible for logistics of playground construction, including permit applications. They will communicate with third party vendors on playground supply purchases and work with finance team on budget needs. They will work specifically with fundraising lead to determine what is donated/what needs to be purchased in regard to building materials. They will need to regularly meet with and update the project manager to ensure the project is on schedule and within budget. As the main point person for construction, they will also work with the DEI specialist to ensure the build is accessible and inclusive.

Community Strategist: Responsibilities include working with local donors to coordinate donated materials for the playground, and for the auction and raffle. They will also be the point

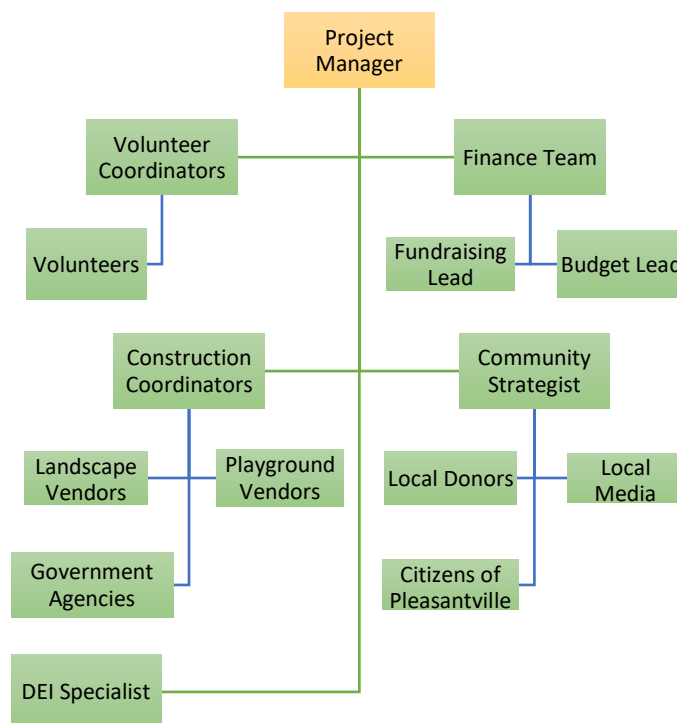
person for any Pleasantville citizen questions or concerns regarding the playground. The strategist will work with local media to promote fundraising events and gala. They will need to meet with the project manager and other leads on a as needed basis for project tasks.

DEI Specialist: The diversity, equity, and inclusion specialist are responsible for researching accessible and inclusive community spaces. They will communicate with the construction coordinator and finance team to determine the best playground design based on budget and materials available. DEI specialist will join construction coordinator on vendor meetings as needed to address any accessibility questions/concerns before purchase. As the DEI subject matter expert, they will also meet regularly with the team to address any DEI concerns throughout the duration of the project.

Additional Volunteers: The project will ideally obtain twenty additional volunteers. They will communicate primarily with the volunteer coordinator and receive guidance from the team leads as applicable.

Responsibilities include assisting with fundraising events, obtaining supplies, and building the playground.

Stakeholder Diagram



GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

The governance structure for this project includes a dedicated team of seven concerned citizens that will take responsibility for various sections of the project; responsibilities are listed in the project team section above. This project is on a tight deadline, with limited weekend availability. The team will use collaborative tools such as virtual meetings, and use of shared drives to share documents to streamline communication and collaboration.

WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE

For full schedule, work breakdown structure (WBS), and network diagram see Microsoft Project attached to submission.

SIX CRITERIA OF COMPLETION DISCUSSION

The swing installation example below illustrates a task from the WBS structure that includes the six criteria of completion. See the table below for reasoning why this example meets those criteria.

1.7 Install playground equipment.

1.7.3 Install swings.

1.7.3.1 Mount swing poles.

1.7.3.2 Connect swing chains.

1.7.3.3 Secure swing chains and seat.

Criteria	Reasoning
The status is measurable and complete	The swing was installed
Start and end date are defined	Start date defined to 7/13, with an estimated 2.5 hours for completion.
The activity has a deliverable	The swing is the deliverable
Time and cost are estimated	Time estimated: 2.5 hours. Cost is estimated because swing has already been purchased high up in the WBS.

Activity duration is within acceptable limits	It will take 2.5 hours for installation; this is an acceptable time limit and will not cause schedule to fall behind.
Work assignments are independent	Each task is done separately in order to complete the swing. Each step is complete and stable before moving on to the next.

SCHEDULE

For full schedule, work breakdown structure (WBS), and network diagram see Microsoft Project attached to submission.

Project duration is from March 8th, 2024, to September 1st, 2024. The completion of the project will be commemorated on City Founders Day on September 1st with a special gala event.

MONITOR AND CONTROL OF PROJECT

To ensure the successful progress of the project, the following measures will be implemented:

1. Bi-weekly meetings will be held with the project team.
2. A shared-drive folder is available, where each team member will be required to document project progress in the communication log.
3. Change management procedure will be documented and available on shared drive.
4. The project manager will keep track of tasks completed in the task spreadsheet.
5. The Gantt chart will be updated as the project progresses.
6. The finance team will regularly update their fundraising and budget documents.
7. Construction coordinators will keep proof of documentation on shared drive that proper permitting has been submitted, and update team on status.
8. Team will create a risk management/mitigation document that will be used when issues arise.

RISK ASSESSMENT AND MITIGATION

The Pleasantville playground project was assessed for risk, and the following risks were determined to be the top three most likely to occur. See below for details including mitigation strategies:

1. **Team and Volunteer Availability** – The 7 main volunteers have limited availability, and it can be difficult to organize meeting times for collaboration. Additional volunteers also have limited availability, often only able to volunteer on the weekend.
 - a. Mitigation: Ensure there is a thorough communication plan set in place with the seven main volunteers and utilize collaborative tools such as the shared drive and communication log. Also ensure a creative recruitment/engagement plan is implemented to recruit as many volunteers as possible.
2. **Overbudget** – there is a risk that the project will cost more than what is fundraised and allotted. There could be a change in the cost of materials to build the playground, or delays which may increase the cost.
 - a. Mitigation: Ensure the cost estimation is conducted accurately, frequently monitor the budget, and implement contingency plans to adjust the budget as needed. The finance and construction team may need to reach out to more local donors for supplies.
3. **Permit/Zoning Issue** – To build on this property, there will be necessary permits and zoning approvals. There may be delays in the approval which could impact the budget and timeline.
 - a. Mitigation: Permitting/Zoning was allotted 30 days in the schedule. Ensure to submit permit application/paperwork as soon as possible. Frequently communicate with regulation authorities and be flexible to complete other tasks while waiting for approval, such as fundraising.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

1. Playground is completed by September 1, 2024. The playground will be fully built and functional for the City Founder's Day Gala.
2. The \$30,000 budget was successfully achieved and adhered to. Through fundraising and donations from the community, the project was financially viable, with minimal unexpected costs.
3. Engagement and participation are achieved by the community and volunteers. The engagement from the community aligns with the project's mission to create a safe space

for community members and foster diversity and inclusion. Many members of the community, including senior citizens, were able to take part in the project.